# The Autonomous SEO Agent Playbook: Build a $1,000/hr SEO Consultant for Free

## Table of Contents

1. Introduction: The "Magic UI" Lie and the Real Revolution
2. Part 1: The "Agentic" SEO Stack (Setup & Strategy)
3. Part 2: The Technical Foundation Audit (The Health Check)
4. Part 3: The GEO & Content Quality Audit (The "E-E-A-T" Layer)
5. Part 4: The Topical Authority Map (The Architecture)
6. Part 5: The "Set-and-Forget" Monthly Loop (Automation)
7. Conclusion

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## Introduction: The "Magic UI" Lie and the Real Revolution

If you spend time on LinkedIn, you have likely seen the post.

A "guru" claims they found a secret Claude tool with a beautiful, simple UI that audits your website in 5 minutes. They ask you to comment "AUDIT" to get access.

**Here is the truth:** That UI does not exist. It is engagement bait designed to farm your data.

But the concept is real. The underlying technology they are alluding to — Claude Skills running on Claude Code — is actually more powerful than the fake tool they are selling.

The reason most marketers haven't used it is that it doesn't live in a web browser. It lives in the Command Line (CLI). To a non-coder, the terminal looks scary. To a modern operator, the terminal is a command center.

### The "Manager/Worker" Architecture

This playbook is not about teaching you to code. It is about teaching you to **orchestrate**. We are going to build an SEO Agency on your desktop using a specific two-layer architecture:

**The Worker (Claude Skills):** These are specialized, open-source rule sets (like `seo-audit` and `web-quality`) created by world-class engineers. They are the "Junior Analysts" that gather the raw data.

**The Manager (Claude Opus 4.6):** This is Anthropic's flagship reasoning model. It is the "Senior Consultant." It takes the raw, messy data from the workers, interprets it, prioritizes it, and tells you exactly how to fix it.

By combining these two, you don't just get a list of errors (which any free tool can do). You get a **Strategic Roadmap** and the **Code Patches** to fix the problems instantly.

You are about to save $1,000/month in consulting fees. Let's build your agent.

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## Part 1: The "Agentic" SEO Stack (Setup & Strategy)

Before we run our first audit, we need to set up the infrastructure.

Most people fail at AI SEO because they rely on "Chat." They copy-paste text into ChatGPT and ask for advice. This is inefficient because the AI cannot "see" your website structure, your code, or your server headers.

We are going to use **Claude Code**, an official tool from Anthropic that allows Claude to run directly on your machine, access the internet, and use "Skills."

### Step 1: The Command Center (Claude Code)

Think of Claude Code not as "coding," but as installing a new Operating System for your marketing.

**Prerequisites:**

- You need an Anthropic API Key (from console.anthropic.com).

- You need Node.js installed on your computer (a simple 1-minute install from nodejs.org).

**The Installation:**

Open your terminal (Command Prompt on Windows / Terminal on Mac) and type this single command:

```
> Loading JavaScript code...
```

Once installed, type `claude` to initialize the agent. It will ask for your API key. Paste it in. You are now live.

## Step 2: Hiring the "Workers" (Installing Skills)

Now we need to teach Claude how to do SEO. By default, Claude is a generalist. We are going to install specific "Skills" (instruction sets) that force it to act like a technical SEO auditor.

We will use two verified, high-performance skills:

**The Generalist Auditor:** `coreyhaines31/marketingskills`

- What it does: Checks meta tags, content structure, internal links, and basic indexability.

**The Technical Specialist:** `addyosmani/web-quality-skills`

- What it does: Created by a Google Chrome engineer, this runs deep Lighthouse checks, Core Web Vitals assessment, and accessibility scans.

**The Installation Commands:**

Paste these into your terminal (inside the Claude interface):

```
> Loading JavaScript code...
```

## Step 3: The "Senior Consultant" Configuration (Opus 4.6)

This is the secret sauce. Standard Claude (Sonnet) is fast, but for deep analysis, we need **Opus 4.6**.

Opus 4.6 has a higher "reasoning capability." It doesn't just see a "404 Error"; it understands the business impact of that error based on where it sits in your funnel.

**The Strategy:**

We will use the Skills to fetch the data, but we will explicitly instruct Opus 4.6 to interpret the data. We treat the output of the skill not as the final report, but as the "Raw Logs" that the Senior Consultant must review.

You have now built a stack that outperforms 90% of human agencies.

- **Cost:** ~$1-2 in API credits per audit.
- **Value:** $1,000+.

Now, let's put them to work.

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## Part 2: The Technical Foundation Audit (The Health Check)

Technical SEO is the foundation. If your site is slow, broken, or confusing to robots, your content doesn't matter.

Agencies charge huge fees for "Technical Audits" that are usually just exported PDFs from software like Screaming Frog. They hand you a list of 500 "Warnings" but don't tell you which ones actually matter.

We are going to use our Agent to find the revenue-killing errors and ignore the noise.

### The Execution

#### 1. Run the Scout

In your Claude terminal, we will dispatch the web-quality-audit skill.

```
> Loading JavaScript code...
```

The Agent will now visit your site. It acts like a browser. It loads the resources, checks the scripts, measures the paint time (LCP), and checks for layout shifts (CLS). It will output a raw JSON or text log of everything it found.

#### 2. The Opus Interpretation (The Filter)

Raw logs are overwhelming. You might see "Unused CSS" warnings that save 2kb of data — irrelevant. You need to know what kills rankings.

```
> Loading JavaScript code...
```

### 3. The Fix (The Code Patch)

Here is where the Agentic workflow shines. A human consultant tells you what is wrong. Opus 4.6 fixes it.

```
> Loading JavaScript code...
```

**Why This Wins:**

You didn't just get a report saying "Fix CLS." You got the actual CSS code to define aspect ratios on your images, preventing the layout shift. You solved the problem in minutes, not weeks.

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# Part 3: The GEO & Content Quality Audit (The "E-E-A-T" Layer)

Traditional SEO audits look for keywords.

Modern AEO (Answer Engine Optimization) audits look for **E-E-A-T** (Experience, Expertise, Authoritativeness, Trust).

AI Search Engines (ChatGPT, Perplexity, Google AI Overviews) prioritize content that demonstrates unique value (Information Gain). If your content is just a rewrite of the top 3 results, the AI will ignore you.

We will use the seo-audit skill to assess your content's "Ingestibility."

## The Execution

### 1. The Content Scan

Dispatch the worker to analyze a specific high-value page (e.g., your main service page).

```
> Loading JavaScript code...
```

### 2. The Competitor Gap Analysis (Information Gain)

Now we bring in Opus 4.6's reasoning. We need to know what your competitors have that you don't.

```
> Loading JavaScript code...
```

**3. The "Machine-Readable" Rewrite**

We don't just want to write for humans; we want to write for the vector database.

```
> Loading JavaScript code...
```

**The Result:**

You now have a page that isn't just "optimized for keywords," but is structured to be the Source of Truth for AI answers. You have increased your "Citable Surface Area."

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# Part 4: The Topical Authority Map (The Architecture)

Google doesn't rank pages; it ranks **Topical Authority**. It wants to know if you are an expert on the entire subject, not just one keyword.

To prove this, you need a perfect Internal Linking structure (The "Spiderweb"). Most sites are messy. They have "Orphan Pages" (pages with no internal links) and "Diluted Hubs" (important pages with few incoming links).

We will use Opus 4.6 to architect your site.

## The Execution

**1. The Sitemap Ingestion**

You need to feed the agent your site structure.

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> Loading JavaScript code...
```

**2. The Hub-and-Spoke Visualization**

Opus 4.6 is exceptional at visualizing relationships in data.

```
> Loading JavaScript code...
```

### 3. The Link Juice Strategy (CSV Output)

Now we get the tactical instructions.

```
> Loading JavaScript code...
```

**Why This Wins:**

You stop guessing where to link. You get a spreadsheet you can hand to a VA (or use the Agent to implement) that scientifically funnels authority to the pages that generate revenue.

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## Part 5: The "Set-and-Forget" Monthly Loop (Automation)

An audit is a snapshot. SEO is a movie.

If you only do this once, your site will rot again in 3 months.

The power of the Autonomous Agent is that it doesn't get bored. We can script this entire process to run automatically every month.

### 1. Creating the Macro

In Claude Code, you can save prompt sequences as "Librettos" or reusable scripts.

**The Logic:**

You want a script that:

- Runs `web-quality-audit` on your Homepage and Top 5 Landing Pages.
- Runs `seo-audit` on your Top 3 Blog Posts.
- Saves the output to a text file.

### 2. The "Diff" Report (The Progress Tracker)

The value isn't just the data; it's the change in data.

```
> Loading JavaScript code...
```

### 3. The Jira/Asana Bridge

Finally, turn insights into work.

```
> Loading JavaScript code...
```

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## Conclusion

You have now moved from "Guesswork SEO" to **Autonomous SEO.**

You have a system that:

- Audits your technical health constantly.
- Strategies your content for the AI era.
- Architects your authority structure.
- Reports on its own progress.

You haven't just saved $1,000/month. You have built an asset that gets smarter, faster, and more accurate every time you run it.

**Your Next Step:**

Open your terminal. Install Claude Code. Run the audit.

The future of search belongs to the **Architects**, not the operators.